

VDB_Checklist

What this is: every VectoraDB feature and its sub-features — built or not, and how it was tested — so it's clear where we are and what's next. How each feature works is in `VDB_Feature_Implemented.pdf` (same ids).

Last updated: 16 September 2026 · **Reflects:** `main @ 7ac2e83` (released as v0.8.4) + the start-notice fix (`fix/update-notice-throttle`)

Source: `docs/VDB_Checklist.html` → `make feature-doc` → this PDF

✓ Done & tested — automated tests (unit, VM integration or CI)

🔸 Partial — gaps, or not verified end to end

Sub-features: ✓ built 🔸 partly ☐ not built yet

✓ Done — tested by hand only

✗ Known issue

☐ Not started

✗ broken · "VM §n" = section of `make integration` ; "v2 §n" = `make integration-v2` ; "update" = `make integration-update`

Where we are

Area	Features	Done & tested	Done (manual)	Partial	Known issue	Not started	Progress
A · Install & setup	9	4	2	3	·	·	67%
B · CLI & services	2	1	·	1	·	·	50%
C · Branching & storage	8	6	1	1	·	·	88%
D · Durability	4	2	·	2	·	·	50%
E · Security foundations	3	2	1	·	·	·	100%
F · SQL gateway	7	6	1	·	·	·	100%
G · Accounts & auth	5	4	·	1	·	·	80%
H · Blackbox (record of schema changes)	18	14	·	4	·	·	78%
I · Import & migration	13	4	8	1	·	·	92%
J · ETL pipelines (experimental)	4	2	2	·	·	·	100%
K · APIs, SDKs & agents	6	1	2	3	·	·	50%
L · Web console	10	·	5	5	·	·	50%
M · Build, CI & releases	6	4	1	1	·	·	83%
Total (features built or started)	95	50	23	22	·	·	77%
N · Not started (roadmap)	11	·	·	·	·	11	0%

Storage engine — not implemented, by design

VectoraDB does **not** have its own storage engine. Data is stored by **PostgreSQL 16's own engine** (heap tables, B-tree indexes, write-ahead log) running on local disk inside the stock `postgres:16-bookworm` image plus `wal-g`. This was a locked architecture decision: a Neon-style engine that separates compute from storage over the network adds latency to every transaction, and transaction speed must never be compromised.

What **is** built is a storage *layer* around Postgres: copy-on-write branch drivers — ZFS on macOS/Linux, btrfs on Windows — behind one interface in `internal/branch/storage.go` (C1), quotas (C6), capacity reporting (C7), and durability to object storage with `wal-g` + MinIO: WAL archiving, base backups, point-in-time restore (D1–D3). Networked storage disaggregation is listed in the README roadmap but not started (see "Not started").

Suggested next steps

- Run `vdb update` against a real release on macOS and Windows (A9) — cut v0.9.0, install it, then update to v0.9.1.
- HA beyond the demo: archive WAL while main runs on the promoted standby, then automatic failover and fencing (D4). (*Safety fixes C3, D4 hazards, H7, I5, I6 done.*)
- Verify downloads everywhere: installers and `vdb setup`'s engine download still skip `SHA256SUMS` (A1, A2, A7).

4. Check the web pages that were built but never used signed in: Integrity, Policies, sidebar (L8–L10); add Blackbox filters (L5); refresh Guide/Docs (L7).
5. Add automated tests where there are none: imports (I1–I3, I5, I7, I8), SDKs (K3, K4), web UI (L*); bring the OpenAPI spec in line (K2).
6. Run the VM integration suites in CI (M2).

A Install & setup

6 of 9 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 A1	One-line installer (macOS / Linux) ✓ Detects OS / CPU, downloads the release binary ✓ Installs to the prefix (sudo only if needed) ✓ Stages the Linux engine for the VM on macOS	Manual
 A2	Windows installer (install.ps1) ✓ Installs WSL, elevates, resumes after reboot ✓ Downloads vdb.exe, engine, image build context ✓ Ubuntu roots verified against Ubuntu's checksums	Pester unit tests (Windows CI)
 A3	vdb setup on macOS (Lima) ✓ Creates / starts the Lima VM ✓ Installs Docker and ZFS ✓ Reinstalls the engine on every run ✓ Starts the stack	Manual (from-scratch VM run)
 A4	vdb setup on Windows (WSL2 + btrfs) ✓ Imports a dedicated distro with systemd ✓ Docker, btrfs and a storage mount unit ✓ Quiet steps, detail in install.log ✓ Waits for systemd on a cold distro	Unit (host_wsl_test.go); manual on Windows
 A5	Linux native ✓ Engine runs in-process, no VM	VM integration (all suites run on Linux)
 A6	Command forwarding & host file streaming ✓ macOS → Lima VM, starts the VM if stopped ✓ Windows → WSL distro	Unit (TestImportLocalFile , TestWSLArgs)
 A7	Always-latest engine binary ✓ Downloads the newest engine into the cache (ELF check)	Unit (host_test.go)
 A8	New-release notice on vdb start ✓ Background check, 1.5 s limit, printed last ✓ Only a promoted, newer, complete release	Unit; update \$1, \$1b, \$2, \$3, \$8; real Mac check
 A9	vdb update ✓ Downloads and verifies everything before changing anything ✓ Stops servers, installs engine, restarts old one on failure ✓ up , Blackbox upgrade, start on the new engine ✓ Replaces host vdb , keeps previous binaries	Unit; update \$4–\$7; a real Mac run

B CLI & services

1 of 2 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 B1	The vdb command set ✓ Stack: setup, start, stop, up, down, status, logs, psql, update ✓ Branching, backup / restore, HA ✓ Blackbox, policy, impact	Unit (main_test.go , update_test.go); VM suites

✓	B2 Background services (daemon)	✓ Control plane :8080, gateway :6432, agent API :8088 ✓ Detached, pidfiles and logs in <code>~/ .vectoradb</code>	✓ Stop (TERM then KILL), status, logs □ Health check / restart on crash	Unit (<code>TestStopTerminatesProcess</code>); VM §1
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C Branching & storage

7 of 8 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
✓ C1	Storage drivers (ZFS / btrfs) ✓ ZFS snapshot + clone per branch (macOS VM, Linux) ✓ btrfs subvolume snapshots (Windows) ✓ Pool / filesystem created on a loopback file	VM §2 (ZFS); btrfs manual on Windows
✓ C2	Branch lifecycle ✓ Create, list, delete ✓ Reset to parent ✓ Suspend / resume	Unit; VM §2, §4
✓ C3	Protection of main ✓ Delete and reset refused	Unit; VM §4, §6
✓ C4	Private networking (no host ports) ✓ Branch databases reachable only through the gateway	Unit (<code>TestParsePublishedPort</code> , <code>TestDSN</code>)
✓ C5	Scale-to-zero & wake on connect ✓ Idle branches suspended automatically ✓ Next connection wakes the branch (~0.3–0.7 s)	VM §7
🟡 C6	Storage quotas ✓ Space reserved for main (ZFS) 🟡 Per-branch cap (opt-in)	Manual
✓ C7	Capacity & status ✓ Services, main health, backups, branches ✓ Storage used / available	VM §1
✓ C8	Provisioning & image pull ✓ Docker, storage pool and image prepared on up	Manual

D Durability

2 of 4 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
✓ D1	WAL archiving to object storage ✓ wal-g ships main's WAL to MinIO, off the commit path	VM §3
✓ D2	Base backups ✓ Create and list □ Schedule and retention	VM §3
🟡 D3	Point-in-time restore ✓ Restore to a timestamp or latest on :5433 ✓ Per-install credentials	VM §3; v2 §1a
🟡 D4	HA standby & failover ✓ Streaming hot standby ✓ Manual failover, main rerouted ✓ Nothing deletes or stops the promoted standby ✓ vdb up brings it back, not the old main	Unit; VM §6, §7

E Security foundations

3 of 3 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 E1	Per-install generated secrets ✓ Generated Postgres and MinIO passwords ✓ Used by restore too	Unit (indirect); v2 §1a
 E2	TLS everywhere ✓ Self-signed TLS on all three services, zero setup 🟡 TLS optional at the gateway (<code>sslmode=disable</code> still connects)	Unit (<code>TestReadStartupUpgradesTLS</code>)
 E3	Zero-signup local API key ✓ First start creates a user, key and connection string 🟡 Windows setup summary doesn't show it	Manual

F SQL gateway

7 of 7 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 F1	Routing by database name ✓ One endpoint :6432, database name = branch ☐ Connection pooling, rate limiting	Unit; VM §1, §6
 F2	API-key authentication ✓ <code>vdb_</code> key as the Postgres password ✓ Bad key rejected with a Postgres error	VM §1
 F3	Backend login (SCRAM) ✓ Cleartext, md5, SCRAM-SHA-256 ✓ Clients never see the database password ☐ Unit test for SCRAM	VM §1, §6, §8 (exercised)
 F4	Per-user Postgres login roles ✓ Role per user, actor can't be forged ✓ Permissions of non-superuser <code>vdbclient</code>	Manual
 F5	Attribution session settings ✓ Actor kind, branch, session id per connection 🟡 Kind / branch / session client-settable	VM §8
 F6	Ctrl-C (CancelRequest) forwarding ✓ Cancel a running query through the gateway	Unit
 F7	Errors & insecure build tag ✓ Real Postgres error responses ✓ No-auth bypass impossible in release builds	Unit (<code>TestSendError</code>)

G Accounts & auth

4 of 5 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 G1	Auth store (SQLite) ✓ Users, keys, sessions, OAuth ids, pipelines ✓ Safe under concurrent use (WAL, busy timeout) ☐ Roles / permissions, multi-tenant projects	Unit (<code>TestVerifyKeyConcurrent</code>)
 G2	Email & password users ✓ Create account, log in ☐ Password change / reset ☐ List and delete users	Unit; VM §1
 G3	API keys ✓ Create (shown once), list, revoke ✓ Bearer / X-API-Key and gateway password 🟡 Revoking an unknown id reports success	Unit; VM §1
 G4	Web sessions & signup control ✓ <code>httpOnly</code> session cookie ✓ Signup can be closed	Unit (<code>TestSessions</code>)
 G5	OAuth (GitHub / Google) ✓ Sign-in flows built ☐ Correct default URLs ☐ Tested with a real OAuth app	None

H Blackbox (record of schema changes)

14 of 18 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
✓ H1	DDL recording ✓ Who, tool, branch, statement, status, risk ✓ Inherited by every branch	VM §8
🕒 H2	Hash chain, append-only & verify ✓ Rows can't be edited or deleted normally ✓ <code>vdb ledger verify</code>	VM §8; v2 §0
🕒 H3	Attribution ✓ Humans via their login role ✓ Agents via their own <code>agent-<id></code> role	VM §8; v2 §1c
🕒 H4	Destructive-DDL guardrail ✓ DROP TABLE / DROP SCHEMA refused, attempt recorded	VM §8; v2 §1b
🕒 H5	Risk flags ✓ Type change, drop column flagged ❑ Per-command matching (not whole query text)	Manual
✓ H6	Blackbox access (CLI / REST / MCP / UI / SDK) ✓ CLI, REST with filters, MCP, web page, SDKs	v2 §0, §5
✓ H7	<code>vdb ledger revert --to</code> ✓ Help and output say it's a point-in-time restore of main	Unit (help text); VM §3 (the restore)
✓ H8	Override permission (<code>vdb_admin</code>) & upgrade ✓ <code>vdb admin grant revoke list</code> ✓ First user granted automatically	v2 §1b
✓ H9	Blackbox 2.0 capture ✓ Transaction id and WAL position per entry ✓ Task, tool-call hash, override use	Unit; v2 §2
✓ H10	Checkpoints & anchors ✓ Merkle root in the database and in read-only anchor files ✓ On a schedule and on demand	Unit; v2 §3, §3b
✓ H11	<code>vdb-verify</code> (independent verifier) ✓ Checks a live branch or an export	Unit; v2 §3
✓ H12	Blackbox integrity & export ✓ INTACT / TAMPERED via CLI, REST, MCP ✓ JSON-lines export	v2 §3
✓ H13	Branch from just before a Blackbox entry ✓ Restore + replay up to the change's transaction ✓ By transaction id or timestamp	Unit; v2 §4
✓ H14	Blackbox names & aliases ✓ <code>vdb blackbox</code>, <code>/blackbox</code> routes, MCP and SDK names	Unit; v2 §5
✓ H15	Policy gate (warn / block) ✓ VDB02 warn / VDB01 block with JSON detail ✓ Blocked attempts recorded ✓ Per-rule <code>vdb_admin</code> override	Unit; v2 §6
✓ H16	Agent provenance & <code>execute_change</code> ✓ Session, task, parent session on every agent change ✓ MCP <code>execute_change</code> with policy preview	Unit; v2 §7

✓	H17 Impact analysis	✓ Dependents (views, foreign keys, indexes, depth) ✓ Other branches that have the object ✓ Policy verdict and risk score	✓ CLI, REST, MCP, inside <code>execute_change</code> 🟡 Functions, types, schemas not recognised from SQL	Unit; v2 §8
✓	H18 Blackbox diff between branches	✓ Fork point, changes only on each side ✓ Objects changed on both	✓ CLI, REST, MCP ☐ Merge (diff only today)	Unit; v2 §8

I Import & migration

12 of 13 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
✓ I1	From Postgres ✓ Schema and data via <code>pg_dump</code> ✓ Zero-table result reported as an error	Manual
✓ I2	From MySQL ≤5.7 / MariaDB ✓ <code>pgloader</code> with type mapping (multi-arch image)	Manual
✓ I3	From MySQL 8.x ✓ Native <code>mysqldump</code> path (caching_sha2 auth) ✓ Types, NULLs, unicode, PK	Manual
✓ I4	From MongoDB ✓ Collection → typed table, exact name	VM §9, §10
✓ I5	From a .sql dump ✓ Runs the dump into a new branch ✓ Fails listing every failed statement (instance kept)	Unit; VM §11
✓ I6	From JSON / NDJSON ✓ Columns inferred from top-level keys	Unit; VM §10, §11
✓ I7	From CSV ✓ Table from the header, exact column names	Manual
🟡 I8	Continuous replication & cutover ✓ Initial copy + streaming (logical replication) ✓ Cutover keeps data (CLI)	Manual
✓ I9	Guard handling during import ✓ Guardrail paused, recording stays on	Manual
✓ I10	Live progress (CLI & SSE) ✓ Live log and progress bar	Manual
✓ I11	Import REST endpoints ✓ From a connection string or an uploaded file	Manual
✓ I12	Web Import page ✓ Database and file panels with live console	Manual
✓ I13	Exact identifier fidelity ✓ Case kept (<code>userId</code> , <code>leaseAiChats</code>)	Unit; VM §10

J ETL pipelines (experimental)

4 of 4 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
✓ J1	Pipeline engine ✓ Extract → raw schema → SQL models → tests, in a fresh branch ✓ <code>ref()</code> / <code>source()</code> templating	Unit; VM §9

✓	J2 Data-quality tests ✓ not_null, unique, accepted_values, row_count_min, custom ✓ Failure → exit 1, data kept	Unit; VM §9
✓	J3 Stored pipelines & run history ✓ Saved per user, run over the API, history □ Read a run's log □ Mark runs whose process died	Manual
✓	J4 Pipeline editor (web) ✓ Create, edit, run, results, history □ Confirm before delete	Manual

K APIs, SDKs & agents 3 of 6 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 K1	Control-plane REST API  Branches, query, Blackbox, policy, impact, import, pipelines, keys  Versioned paths (/api/v1)	Unit; VM §1; v2 §0–§8
 K2	OpenAPI spec  Served, Blackbox 2.0 endpoints documented  Match the code (import fields, status codes, missing routes)	Manual
 K3	Python SDK  Branches, query, Blackbox  Tests  Import, pipelines, keys, agents  Publish to PyPI	Manual
 K4	TypeScript SDK  Same client for Node and browsers  Publish to npm  Tests	Manual
 K5	Agent Branch API  A branch per agent, own non-superuser role  DSN only reachable inside the VM  Provenance (task, parent, session)  Cap and TTL count only running branches	VM §5; v2 §1c, §7
 K6	MCP server  Branches, run_sql, Blackbox tools  Authentication  policy_check, execute_change, impact, diff  Client config snippet in docs	Unit; v2 §1c–§8

L Web console 5 of 10 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 L1	Embedded single-origin UI ✓ Served by the engine at :8080 ❑ Automated UI tests (whole area)	Manual
 L2	Login & signup ✓ Log in / sign up tabs, OAuth buttons	Manual
 L3	Dashboard ✓ Live tiles ✓ Branch table: create, suspend, resume, delete, copy DSN	Manual
 L4	SQL console & browser ✓ Schema sidebar, rows, structure, indexes ✓ SQL editor	Manual
 L5	Blackbox page ✓ Entries per branch with badges ❑ Table / risk / date filters ❑ Verify button, statement and session	Manual
 L6	API keys page ✓ Create, copy, list, revoke	Manual
 L7	Landing, Guide & Docs pages ✓ Landing, developer guide, reference ❑ Refresh stale content (https, sslmode, MCP, Blackbox, import routes)	Manual
 L8	Blackbox integrity page ✓ Verify, checkpoint, export, branch-before ❑ Used in a browser against a running stack	Type-check + build

	L9 Policies page ✓ Rules, warn/block, custom rules, preview, evaluations □ Used in a browser against a running stack	Type-check + build; API in v2 §6
	L10 App sidebar layout ✓ Grouped sidebar, collapse, mobile drawer □ Reviewed in a browser while signed in	Type-check + build; served preview

M

Build, CI & releases

5 of 6 done

ID	Feature · sub-features	Tested by
 M1	Makefile targets ✓ build, vet, test, integration suites ✓ release, web, WSL builds, feature-doc (both PDFs)	CI
 M2	Linux CI ✓ Build, vet, test, gofmt ✓ Release script tests, checklist sync check □ VM integration suites in CI	CI
 M3	Windows CI ✓ Build, vet, test, Pester, installer encoding □ End-to-end WSL install test	CI
 M4	Releases & GHCR image ✓ Binaries for 5 platforms + vdb-verify ✓ SHA256SUMS merged safely between jobs ✓ Fails unless vdb update 's files are published ✓ Multi-arch Postgres image on GHCR	Script tests in CI
 M5	WSL distro & ZFS builds ✓ Prebuilt distro image □ Used by the installer □ Preloaded image tag fixed	Actions artifacts
 M6	Postgres image ✓ Postgres 16 + wal-g □ pgvector	Manual

N Not started (roadmap)

11 items

Planned or discussed, nothing built yet. When work starts, move the row into its area with the next id there.

ID	Item · scope	Related
☐ -	Multi-tenant projects & roles ☐ Projects / organisations ☐ Per-branch permissions (RBAC)	G1, H6
☐ -	Branch merge ☐ Apply one branch's schema changes to another	H18
☐ -	Scheduled backups & retention	D2
☐ -	Automatic HA failover ☐ Health detection, fencing ☐ Multi-host	D4
☐ -	Pipelines: scheduling, incremental / CDC extract, DAG view	J1
☐ -	More import sources: Cassandra, DynamoDB	I1–I8
☐ -	pgvector in the Postgres image	M6
☐ -	Cloud write-once anchors (S3 Object Lock etc.)	H10
☐ -	Release signatures	A9, M4
☐ -	Hosted cloud tier	—
☐ -	Networked storage disaggregation (README roadmap; see the storage engine note on page 1)	C1, D1

Out of scope by decision

A custom storage engine (PostgreSQL's own engine is used, for native transaction speed), sharding, Raft / distributed transactions, multi-region, HTAP.